



Final Study Guide

Introductory Psychology

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1 Introduction

This is the instructor-provided study guide for the final exam for PSY-101. Please use this document as **one** of the aids in preparing for this exam, but I strongly encourage you to develop additional study aids and tools on your own. This document is **not meant to be comprehensive** to all of the content covered in modules 7 - 12 - it is a merely a summary of what was covered, and meant as a review tool to help guide your practice.

[Final / Exam 2 Structure](#) covers the basic policies and procedures of the test, with information lifted directly from the syllabus. [Tips for Preparing](#) highlights what I feel are good practices to employ as you get ready to take the test. [Tips for Studying](#) contains ideas on what additional steps you can take to help get ready for the exam and [Responsible Use of AI Tools in Studying]. [Vocabulary](#) contains many (but not necessarily all) of the important terms and phrases used in the last 6 modules, and [Learning Objectives](#) has the all of the learning objectives for each module, as they appeared on each weekly lecture and overview.

Please do feel free to reach out with any questions you may have, but also make ready use of these many opportunities and resources to do well. I believe in each of you to use your time and diligence to turn in an excellent performance on this test.

2 Final / Exam 2 Structure

Please review the following information and procedures regarding the midterm and final exams in this course. The following text is also in the syllabus.

There may be additional section-specific policies relevant to the exam; please check the syllabus for the most accurate description of the exam as it is relevant to your section, read recent course announcements made on Blackboard, and reach out to the instructor via email with any additional questions

There will be 2 exams in this course, effectively a midterm and a final. These exams are intended to be **non-cumulative** and will cover content from all units and quizzes since the prior test. In practice, this means that the midterm will only cover the first half of the course, and **the final exam will only cover the second half of the course (modules 8 through 12).**

The format is as follows:

- Each exam is 50 multiple-choice questions, 2 points for each question
- Exams will contain content from the entire unit, between all lectures AND readings and any other activities
- Exams are timed, 60 minutes only (used to be 50 minutes)
- Exams are not open-note, open-book, or collaborative. You are not permitted to use any form of assistance other than what is explicitly provided by the instructor. Do not discuss the tests with other students after it has concluded

- You should not be speaking, texting, or calling with other people during the exam. You should not be holding, using, or referring to any phone, tablet, or other electronic device during the exam. You should not be wearing any headphones, earbuds, headsets, or other ear devices (unless it is pre-approved as an accommodation for medical reasons)
- Failure to adhere to the above guidelines may result in an automatic failure on the exam, if it raises the suspicion of un-authorized help during the exam, at the discretion of the instructor. Multiple failures to adhere to the rules of the exam may result in dismissal from class and referral to GVSU administration for further disciplinary action.
- Exams will be graded promptly and reviewed as soon as possible; the correct answers to the questions will also be provided.

3 Tips for Preparing

The below pieces of advice are my opinionated thoughts about how you may successfully prepare for this exam. Each student may find different strategies and techniques useful, please customize the following advice to your own needs.

- Because the exam is fairly comprehensive, you should make sure to review any materials relevant to the content we've covered in class, which may include:
 - Any and all lecture notes taken, whether that be the guided notes filled out or your own personal notes
 - Printed copies of your lecture check-ins
 - Any notes or activities you've completed from the book as additional practice
 - Any additional handwritten or student-typed preparation, such as answers to this study guide
- If you suspect that you may be absent or miss the exam window, you should contact the instructor as soon as possible
- If you have a documented accommodation for this course, you should work with the instructor to ensure that the exam format will be adequately address your needs, and work to make other arrangements for taking the test if necessary
- Try to get a good night of sleep for the several nights leading up to the exam
- Follow your usual diet leading up to the exam; try not to eat new foods that may upset your stomach and/or disrupt your attention while you attempt to exam
- If you normally consume it, keep your usual habits of consuming a healthy dose of caffeine leading up to the exam
- Dress in layers that you can add or take off to remain comfortable temperature-wise, during testing
 - However, do not wear any hoods up or hats that obscure your ears and may raise concern that you are wearing any earbuds

The below bullet points are only relevant to online sections of this course:

- You should take the exam on a laptop or desktop computer, not a tablet or phone. You should have your computer plugged in during the exam to reduce risk of battery running out, and should warn others you live with to not disturb you until you are done
- Find a quiet, secluded spot with good internet connection and an outlet for your computer. You may want to take the exam in a different place than your dorm room, if you feel that your roommates may not give you adequate private space to take the exam
- Place any other devices and distractions (e.g., phone, earbuds, etc.) in another room or away in a bag, unless necessary for medical or academic accommodations (which should be discussed with the instructor)
- Please do not have any snacks or drinks while taking the exam, as their packaging may raise the concerns of cheating. Keep your workspace entirely clear of any materials or devices that could be perceived as cheating

4 Tips for Studying

The below pieces of advice are my opinionated thoughts about how you may successfully study for this exam. Each student may find different strategies and techniques useful, please customize the following advice to your own needs.

- For the most part, **the exam is based upon the content covered in the lectures, slides, and guided notes.** I do my best to test upon the content we covered through the content I created, rather than small details from the book or other resources. When in doubt, focus your time on understanding the content covered in lecture, using additional resources to refine your understanding when confused.
- As a general rule: **create, don't consume!** The best study materials are the ones that you make and develop. While I give you this document as a starting point, you should make the notes and study materials that are best suited to *you*. The process of developing study materials on your own will help cement the content for you.
- **Give yourself enough time to study!** Good studying starts early, and remains consistent. There is simply too much material to making cramming an effective strategy. Starting studying only the night before an exam will likely be insufficient for getting you a good grade.
- **Be honest with yourself about your ability on the content!** Too many students seem to “gaslight” themselves into believing they “know” the content, just by re-reading their notes (I've done it myself). It never hurts to test or quiz yourself and admit when you struggle on a certain area or topic. **Do not just “re-read” your notes as a way to study**

- **DO NOT use this study guide as your sole resource when studying.** I provided this guide as a convenience, but I make no certain guarantee that it contains any and all information relevant to the exam. Any of the content covered in lectures or reading is fair game to be tested upon - and you should use resources from those things to prepare. Completion of this study guide does not necessarily guarantee success on the actual exam.
- If you do not know where to start:
 - First, focus on the [Vocabulary](#) and being able to organically come up with definitions and explanations for those terms. This is where many students may opt to use flashcards or spaced repetition software like Quizlet or Anki. Make sure that when you are using those flashcards, that you are *testing* yourself, not merely reading the flashcards - this will help you memorize the concepts
 - Second, work through the [Learning Objectives](#) - and test yourself upon those: try to write out responses to each of those objectives *without* looking at your notes
 - Third, take a look at the practice questions in your book and try answering them without your notes, checking your answers when you are finished and writing out your explanations
 - Between these two steps: if you can give good definitions to all of the vocabulary, and can address each of the learning objectives *without your notes*, then you are likely in a good spot
- Try “teaching” the materials to an (un)willing volunteer or inanimate object
 - Trying to teach through and explain a concept will immediately make it apparent whether you understand it, or do not. This is how I double-check myself when writing lectures: if I can’t explain something fluidly, then I haven’t truly mastered explaining it well enough yet.
 - You could even try using my slides and see if you can talk “between the lines” and go beyond what is just written down - lecturing on a certain piece of content can actually really help you reinforce your understanding.
- Review past quizzes and lecture check-in answers; ensure you have corrected your understanding where you may have gotten a question wrong the first time through. If you completed the “midterm exam reconciliation” assignment - consider doing a similar process, but for each of the quizzes, to help fix or refine previous confusion you had
- Consider “re-annotating” your previous notes:
 - Add question marks where you are confused on something
 - Add highlights to parts that stick out as especially critical to understanding
 - Re-work discussion and multiple choice questions strewn throughout the lecture guided notes and make sure you have good answers for each of them
- Complete practice and review questions at the end of each chapter of the textbook, your textbook has many useful activities for thinking through and practicing the concepts of the class; many students do not realize how useful these practices can

be for preparing

- Consider coming to office hours the instructor to clarify difficult topics

5 Responsible Uses of AI Tools in Studying

I generally caution against use of AI in studying and the educational process in general, because many students (in my experience) use it in a way that deprives them of learning, rather than enhancing it. *But*, I do believe there is a way to use it to assist in the learning and memorization process. Let me give some examples of what to do and what not to do:

- As a general rule, **always double-check with your notes and textbook to ensure you get accurate answers - AI IS NOT INFALLIBLE**
- Avoid using plain 'explanation' prompts with no follow-up:
 - E.g., "Explain behaviorism to me", "Tell me the lobes of the brain"
 - While such a question may *feel* like it helps, you likely won't actually remember what it says unless you use that explanation to do something like write a definition in your own words
 - This is a good starting point for clarifying things, but won't help in the broad scheme of things past that
- Use it to generate tools like mnemonics or tricks for assisting memorization:
 - E.g., "Make me an easy-to-remember acronym or mnemonic for remembering the lobes of the brain and their general functions"
 - If you actually practice memorization with these shortcuts, you can likely really benefit from these!
- Use it to make some mock or test questions based on your notes:
 - E.g., Upload your notes and ask, "Make me some example multiple-choice and short answer questions based on this document, and give me explanations for each one"
 - May have mixed results depending on how well the AI can "read" your notes
 - Make sure you actually test yourself and correct your understanding, not just using the answer key to make you "think" you know the correct answer, when you can't really explain it
- Use it to make short passage examples of certain principles in practice:
 - E.g., "Write me 4 examples of classical conditioning of behavior using positive reinforcement, negative reinforcement, positive punishment, and negative punishment"

6 Vocabulary

The terms in this section have been lifted from the textbook bolded terms and may not have been used directly in lecture, though I have tried to remove those not explicitly covered by my recordings. If you cannot find a clear definition or example, consider looking at the end of each chapter for the author-provided definition, or review the video from the respective module to see my explanation again.

Some terms may be duplicated due to having appeared as bolded terms in multiple chapters, consider their relevance to the context of each module.

6.1 Module 8

acoustic encoding	recall
active rehearsal	recognition
Atkinson and Shiffrin Model	rehearsal
automatic processing	relearning
effortful processing	retrieval
elaborate rehearsal	self-reference effect
encoding	semantic encoding
episodic memory	semantic memory
explicit memory	semantic networks
implicit memory	sensory memory
memory	short-term memory
memory consolidation	storage
priming	visual encoding
procedural memory	

6.2 Module 9

accommodate	cognitive theory of development
assimilate	continuous development
cognitive development	developmental milestones

developmental psychologist	nurture
discontinuous development	physical development
lifespan	psychosexual theory of development
moral theory of development	psychosocial development
nature	psychosocial theory of development
normative approach	

6.3 Module 10

cognitive appraisal	intrinsic motivation
component of emotions	metabolic rate
drive theory	motivation
emotion	overjustification effect
experiences	physiological responses
expressions	satiation
extrinsic motivation	self-efficacy
Hierarchy of needs	set-point theory
homeostasis	social motivation
instinct	

6.4 Module 11

anal stage	genital stage
analytical psychology	id
conscious	inferiority complex
defense mechanism	latency stage
ego	neurosis
erogenous zone	oral stage
fixation	personality
four-humors theory	phallic stage

phrenology theory	social tasks
pleasure theory	social-cognitive theory of personality
reality principle	superego
reciprocal determinism	unconscious

6.5 Module 12

anxiety disorders	hoarding disorder
atypical	international classification of diseases (ICD)
bipolar and related disorders	mania
body dysmorphic disorder	mood disorders
comorbidity	obsessive-compulsive and related disorders
delusions	obsessive-compulsive disorder
depressive disorders	panic disorder
diagnosis	Posttraumatic stress disorder (PTSD)
diagnostic and statistical manual of mental disorders (DSM)	psychological/mental disorder
etiology	psychopathology
flashbacks	safety behaviors
generalized anxiety disorder (GAD)	schizophrenia
hallucinations	social anxiety disorder
harmful dysfunction	specific phobia

7 Learning Objectives

This is a list of the learning objectives, as they appeared through the module overviews/checklist and lectures

7.1 Module 8

- Discuss the three basic functions of memory
- Describe the three stages of memory storage

- Describe and distinguish between procedural and declarative memory and semantic and episodic memory
- Explain the brain functions involved in memory
- Recognize the roles of the hippocampus, amygdala, and cerebellum
- Compare and contrast the two types of amnesia
- Discuss the unreliability of eyewitness testimony
- Discuss encoding failure
- Discuss the various memory errors
- Compare and contrast the two types of interference
- Make sure you can connect memory back to the all important brain structures!
- Be able to apply the concepts of memory to anecdotal and narrative examples
- Be able to apply an understanding of memory vocabulary to your own life

7.2 Module 9

- Define and distinguish between the three domains of development: physical, cognitive and psychosocial
- Discuss the normative approach to development
- Understand the three major issues in development: continuity and discontinuity, one common course of development or many unique courses of development, and nature versus nurture
- Discuss Freud's theory of psychosexual development
- Describe the major tasks of child and adult psychosocial development according to Erikson
- Discuss Piaget's view of cognitive development and apply the stages to understanding childhood cognition
- Describe Kohlberg's theory of moral development
- Compare and contrast the strengths and weaknesses of major developmental theories
- Be able to identify key characteristics and ideas from the different developmental theories
- Be able to connect the different theorists to their views and perspectives
- Be able to apply the different developmental stages, given a specific age in an example

7.3 Module 10

- Define intrinsic and extrinsic motivation
- Understand that instincts, drive reduction, self-efficacy, and social motives have all been proposed as theories of motivation
- Explain the basic concepts associated with Maslow's hierarchy of needs
- Describe how hunger and eating are regulated
- Differentiate between levels of overweight and obesity and the associated health consequences

- Explain the health consequences resulting from anorexia and bulimia nervosa
- Explain the major theories of emotion
- Connect different needs with previously covered topics such as development, humanistic psychology, biopsychology
- Understand how our physical body and structures continue to play a role in our behavior, affect, and cognition
- Start to see how psychological dysfunction can arise to clinically-concerning conditions

7.4 Module 11

- Define personality
- Describe early theories about personality development
- Describe the assumptions of the psychodynamic perspective on personality development
- Define and describe the nature and function of the id, ego, and superego
- Define and describe the defense mechanisms
- Define and describe the psychosexual stages of personality development
- Discuss the concept of the inferiority complex
- Discuss the core differences between Erikson's and Freud's views on personality
- Discuss Jung's ideas of the collective unconscious and archetypes
- Discuss the work of Karen Horney, including her revision of Freud's "penis envy"
- Describe the behaviorist perspective on personality
- Describe the cognitive perspective on personality
- Describe the social cognitive perspective on personality
- Be able to classify theories under the general category they belong to, and identify the perspective/paradigm that the respective theorists belong to
- Appreciate the complexity of different perspectives in personality theories - compare and contrast this with the diverse theories of learning, development, etc.
- Be able to differentiate between the different foci of different theories, and use the correct vocabulary when describing them

7.5 Module 12

- Focus on the complexity in discriminating between different classes and types of mental disorders and their unique characteristics